



>>Sanket Atal, Group Vice President, Product Development, Oracle India>>

>> On the occasion of Java's 20-year anniversary we have a heart-to-heart about Oracle's future roadmap and more. >

Mithun: Why would startups prefer big vendors like oracle for developing their middleware as compared to open source alternatives that they generally tend to go for?

Sanket: As a company, Oracle is going through a major transformation right now and the mantra is that we are becoming a cloud first and mobile first company which is embracing the direction the entire technology landscape is heading into.

Now we have been in the area for quite sometime in various ways and most recently there has been a big announcement of our PaaS offerings, when we announced 24 services that people can use to basically leverage Oracle Fusion Middleware's strength. As you know the whole idea behind PaaS and the cloud is to essentially enable everybody to be able to leverage these technologies in a very easy manner. For example, Startups have to tackle some major barriers to entry. Some of which are the ability to host the application that they are developing, access to a framework that they can use and to be able to develop an industrial strength framework for their application. And the cloud gives access to great software at a very reasonable entry point. So they can get to market very quickly.

The two things that startups need is being able to develop their technology and the second is marketing. Marketing

has become easy thanks to quick and easy access to wonderful digital marketing software etc. and increased Internet penetration. And on the development side we are providing cloud solutions, particularly PaaS solutions to allow rapid development. So this is going to change the landscape quite a bit and we operate in all levels of the cloud – IaaS, PaaS, SaaS. We are a platform for startups to get their leg in the door.

Mithun: Does Oracle have any programmes (with revenue sharing models) to encourage startups to adopt more of Oracle's products?

Sanket: So Oracle as a company is very much dedicated to ensuring that the people can leverage the technology, to be able to grow. And in the startup world to be able to get their leg in the door.

The whole idea of the cloud being a great enabler for startups is a very important concept for us. As far as actual programs similar to the ones that you've mentioned, I don't believe we have declared any major programs like that currently but that's not saying we wouldn't do something like those in the future.

And I personally believe that if you take a look at the comprehensive set of services that we have, a lot of the needs are met and they enable startups to implement their product. For this they might need access to a data storage, identity management, tight security, and perhaps they'd want to introduce some business processes etc. plus they'd want to do analytics.

So in one platform you get the leverage to do all of these and you don't have to incur the cost of all the typical hardware acquisition, people acquisition to manage the hardware, software acquisition, platform acquisition etc. All of that is taken away and you are able to jump in with both feet very very quickly and I think that's the biggest benefit of the cloud offerings in Oracle's portfolio.

Mithun: Could you tell us some of the important highlights of Java 9?

Sanket: Here's what we are trying to do. Oracle R&D, as you know, is a large entity and it's truly global with a strength of about 30,000+ and more than a third of that happens to be in India. A significant part of Java development happens in India as well.

The way development happens in a global organisation that is spread around

the world is that, each one is a true peer, everyone gets to work on cutting edge technology. And we, at Oracle India, have played a very active part in Java 9's development as the ongoing process of maintenance of existing java releases etc.

One feature of Java 9, which we call Project Jigsaw internally, is getting a lot of recognition, and I think it's a great visualization of what you can achieve with it. The goal of this is modularity. When you are putting together an application, i.e. a java based application; you'd like to be able to package it in a manner that is fairly lightweight. What we allow you to do is to be able to declaratively select the various parts of the java platform that you need and package that, rather than going on all out and including everything that's provided because it's a very very rich platform.

There's another thing that I want to underscore in Java 8. One thing that is happening quite a bit is that every year there is a new language that comes out which is very interesting to work with on your client side stuff etc. Now what we provide is the ability for you to execute quite a bit on JVM, so your platform remains the same but you are able to leverage the power of all of these languages on the same platform. And that is something that I think about Java that is not very well known.

Mithun: So let's say a startup that's starting out goes with open source solution but later needs to adopt OFM. Given such a scenario, will the shift to oracle fusion middleware end up requiring complete overhaul of the system or is it seamlessly?

Sanket: Basically, we have a steadfast focus on compliance with industry standards. For us, that has been a mantra for a very long time. So applications that are standards compliant can easily migrate to OFM, without much work. And we have implemented the ability for you to migrate your services to the cloud and vice versa using a click of a button in a very painless way. The whole beauty is that it's modular and you can easily integrate your services into a complex topology whether it's all Oracle or hybrid. So a heterogeneous setup is perfectly valid to leverage Oracle technologies whether it's a couple of services or an entire setup purely using Oracle's services.

Read the entire interview online:

<http://dgit.in/DevworxSA> >